

Anna Zhang

annaz94264@gmail.com ♦ (925) 336-2555 ♦ linkedin.com/in/annazhang06 ♦ annazhang006.github.io/portfolio/

EDUCATION

University of California Santa Cruz, Santa Cruz, CA

B.S. Computer Science: Game Design | B.S. Cognitive Science

Expected Graduation Spring 2028

GPA: 3.81/4.0, **Dean's List:** 3 Quarters

Relevant Coursework: Foundations of Video Game Design, Game Development Experience, Research Methods in Psychology, Programming Abstractions: Python, Applied Discrete Mathematics

SKILLS

- **Programming Languages:** Python, C, Javascript
- **Product & Research:** User Research, Requirements Definition, Ambiguous-Problem Scoping, Competitive/Literature Analysis, Experimental Design, Cross-Functional Collaboration
- **Data & Analysis:** Excel, Google Sheets, Survey Design, Data Visualization, Social Analytics
- **Software:** Canva, WordPress, Word, PowerPoint, Adobe Illustrator, Google Workspace
- **Language:** Mandarin (Professional Working Fluency)

EXPERIENCE

Santa Cruz Dragon Boat, Santa Cruz, CA

June 2025 – June 2026

Social Chair

- Analyzed engagement data (post reach, follower growth) across Instagram and TikTok to identify which content formats resonated, using those insights to redirect strategy, +80% post reach, +10% followers in 6 months.
- Led entrepreneurial outreach efforts, independently securing \$600+ in partner/sponsor support through tailored proposals and relationship-building.

College Leadership and Engagement Office, Santa Cruz, CA

September 2026 – Present

Programs Assistant

- Led end-to-end project management for 10+ campus programs (100–400+ attendees), from requirements through execution.
- Reconciled competing priorities (accessibility, accommodations, engagement) across ResLife, Student Government, and the Provost's Office to scope each event.
- Redesigned program structure to close awareness gaps, then iterated using participant feedback.

Ben Storm Memory Lab, Santa Cruz, CA

March 2025 – Present

Research Assistant

- Coordinated recruitment, session facilitation, and data entry for 100+ participants across 2 studies, maintaining rigorous experimental protocol to ensure clean, usable data
- Attended weekly lab meetings and contributed to review of multiple ongoing project presentations, engaging with research design and methodology decisions across the team's portfolio of studies

White Stag Leadership Academy, Monterey, CA

September 2021 – September 2024

Senior Patrol Counselor, Assistant Senior Patrol Leader, Patrol Counselor

- Designed and led two week-long leadership programs for 100+ youth participants, raising engagement scores 30% by iterating on post-camp survey feedback while directing multi-day logistics for 100+ participants
- Delivered 1,400+ volunteer hours per year while maintaining a full academic course load

RELEVANT PROJECTS

Foodie Chase - 2D Platformer | CPM 120, UC Santa Cruz | <https://anna-zhang6.github.io/FastFoodie/>

- Solo-designed and shipped a 4-level 2D platformer in one month using JavaScript and Phaser 3, from concept through public deployment on GitHub Pages
- Built a food-themed chase mechanic with a pursuing enemy, implementing pursuit logic, collision detection, and difficulty pacing to keep each level tense but fair
- Balanced level design and enemy behavior across all 4 levels through iterative playtesting, delivering a complete, polished game under a hard one-month deadline

UCSC Mini Campus Explorer - Team Game Project (2025) - GDevelop, GitHub

- Built and committed quest/NPC event logic (JSON-based configuration) to a public GitHub repo with a 4-person team, while defining core product requirements and scoping features to a one-quarter timeline
- Ran structured playtests with classmates, informal user research, logged findings as GitHub issues, and prioritized fixes based on player feedback to hit milestone deadlines, an early customer-discovery-to-requirements loop

ACTIVITIES, & HONORS

- **Presidential Volunteer Service Award (Gold)**, Recipient

2022 – 2024